MARCH

2026 MONTHLY THREAT REPORT

MISBAR

Executive Summary

Welcome to the Misbar assessment of March 2026's cybersecurity landscape, spotlighting the relentless rise of ransomware campaigns and critical vulnerability exploits that defined the month's threats. Even amid aggressive law enforcement actions and ecosystem disruptions, adversaries demonstrated remarkable adaptability leveraging refined Ransomware-as-a-Service (RaaS) models, zero-day flaws, and automated attack chains to maximize disruption with minimal friction.

This month revealed a threat environment optimized for speed and scale. Groups like Qilin and Medusa executed double-extortion playbooks across healthcare, government, and infrastructure targets, exploiting unpatched vulnerabilities in Microsoft Office, Cisco networks, and VMware platforms to achieve rapid initial access and widespread impact. Interconnected ecosystems amplified the fallout single compromises in supply chains and identity systems rippled into multi-week outages and multimillion-dollar ransoms, underscoring how trusted relationships and automated processes have become adversaries' most potent weapons.

These developments demand a shift beyond prevention alone. In 2026, true resilience spanning rapid detection, zero-trust segmentation, immutable backups, and cross-team recovery playbooks must be embedded across every layer of operations and partnerships to contain risk escalation.

The Misbar Team serves as your vantage point into this evolving battlefield. We uncover emerging vulnerabilities sooner, prioritize exposures critical to your environment, and deliver actionable intelligence to fortify defenses against tomorrow's threats. We hope this report empowers your strategies for the year ahead.

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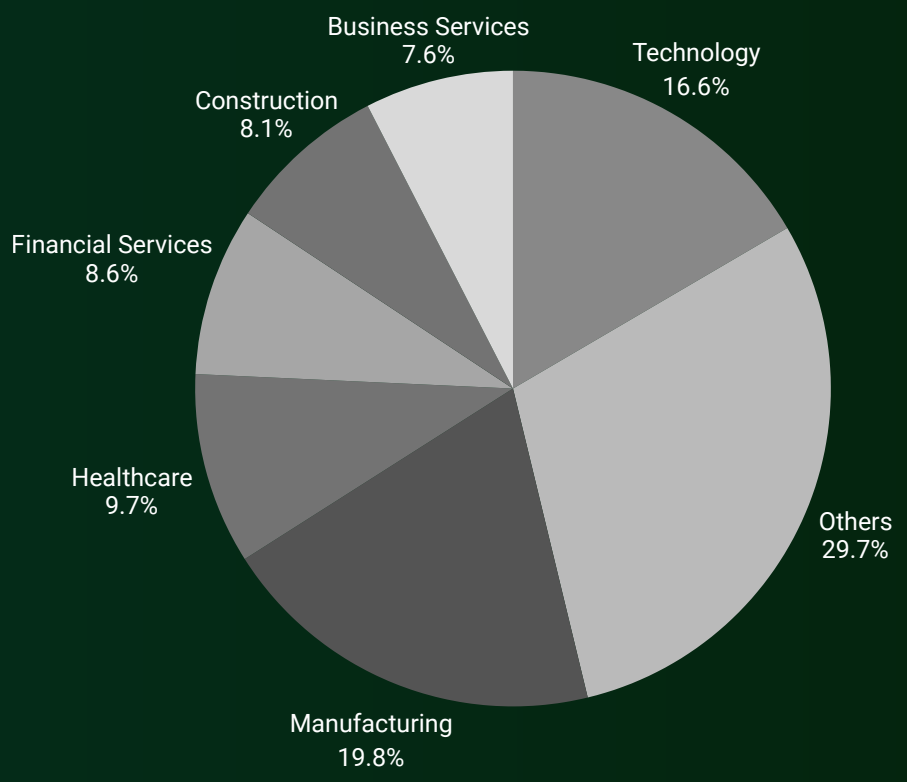
Ransomware Landscape

March 2026 marked a watershed moment in cybercrime evolution, as ransomware operations achieved unprecedented scale and sophistication. With 327 distinct active groups coordinating through mature Ransomware-as-a-Service (RaaS) platforms, attackers claimed 689 victims this month alone contributing to 26,844 total victims tracked and 2,199 this year. This volume represents a sustained 30%+ surge over prior periods, driven by industrialized attack infrastructure that prioritizes speed, automation, and maximum economic impact across global targets.

Detailed Sector Exposure

The month's victim distribution reveals clear attacker preferences for high-value, disruption-sensitive industries:

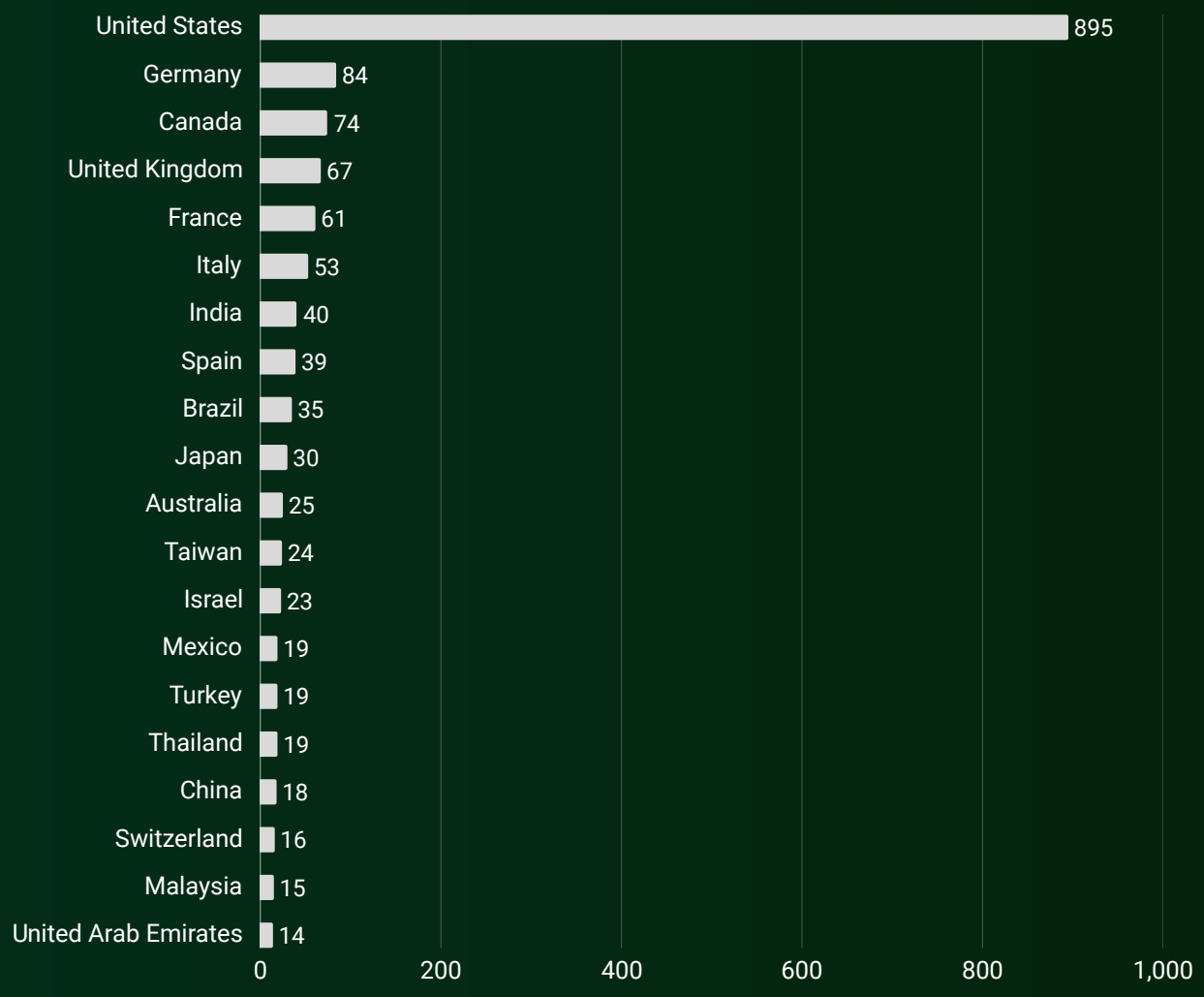


March 2026 ransomware victims by sector

The chart highlights manufacturing as the most affected sector, accounting for 19.8% of observed victims, followed by technology at 16.6%. The distribution across healthcare, financial services, construction, and business services suggests that ransomware operators continue to target a broad range of industries, particularly those where operational disruption can increase pressure to pay.

Geographic Distribution

Although the United States remained the dominant target, ransomware activity was broadly distributed across Europe and other major markets, with Germany, Canada, the United Kingdom, France, Italy, and India also recording notable victim counts. This suggests that threat actors continue to prioritize countries with large digital footprints, mature enterprise environments, and high likelihood of ransom payment.



Geographic distribution of observed ransomware victims

The chart highlights the strong concentration of ransomware victims in the United States, while also showing notable activity across Europe, Asia, and other major markets. This reflects the global reach of ransomware operations and the continued targeting of digitally mature, high-value environments.

Most Active Ransomware Groups

The ransomware landscape continues to be shaped by a relatively small group of highly active operators that maintain a consistent and visible presence across the reporting period. This section highlights the threat groups that demonstrated notable activity, helping to illustrate which actors were most operationally persistent and influential within the broader ransomware ecosystem. Reviewing these groups also provides useful context on how activity is concentrated among a limited number of operators, even as the wider threat landscape remains crowded and constantly evolving.

Group	Victims (Last 30 Days)	Last Victim
Qilin	131	3/28/2026
Akira	69	3/27/2026
DragonForce	57	3/27/2026
The Gentlemen	52	3/23/2026
NightSpire	48	3/29/2026

Top 5 Active Ransomware Groups

Over the last 30 days, ransomware activity was led by Qilin, which recorded 131 victims, making it the most active group during the period. It was followed by Akira with 69 victims, DragonForce with 57, and TheGentlemen with 52, while NightSpire and IncRansom each recorded 48 victims. This distribution shows that a relatively small number of groups accounted for a significant share of observed activity, reinforcing the concentration of operational momentum among a few highly active ransomware operators.

Among these groups, Qilin is commonly associated with ransomware-as-a-service activity and double-extortion operations, making it one of the more operationally significant actors in the current ransomware landscape. Akira has maintained a strong presence through sustained campaigns and broad targeting, while DragonForce is typically observed as an extortion-driven actor that uses public victim disclosures to increase pressure on affected organizations. In contrast, groups such as TheGentlemen and NightSpire appear less extensively profiled in public reporting, yet their activity demonstrates how quickly newer or lower-visibility operators can gain traction and contribute to an increasingly fragmented ransomware ecosystem.

Vulnerability Landscape

March 2026 recorded a notable increase in published CVEs, with 5,799 vulnerabilities disclosed during the month, compared with 4,619 in February and 4,313 in January. This sharp rise suggests that the vulnerability landscape continued to expand as the first quarter progressed, increasing the volume of exposures that security teams needed to assess, prioritize, and remediate.

5799	34	2650	2256	%25.5
Vulnerabilites	KEV	Affected Products	High Severity	increase in published CVEs

This month was a particularly active month for vulnerability disclosure, with total published CVEs rising by 25.5% compared with February. Beyond the overall volume, the large number of high-severity vulnerabilities and affected products indicates that defenders were not only dealing with more disclosures, but also with a broader and more complex exposure landscape. The presence of Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEVs) further underscores that a portion of these flaws had already moved beyond disclosure into active threat activity, increasing the urgency of prioritization and remediation.

The month averaged 167.4 CVEs per day, while year-over-year growth reached 27.3%, with 14,731 CVEs disclosed year to date compared with 11,575 during the same period in 2025. Together, these figures show that organizations are facing not only a growing volume of vulnerabilities, but also a faster and more sustained pace of disclosure.

Top Affected Vendors

Some vendors stood out in March 2026 due to both the volume of vulnerabilities disclosed across their products and the potential security impact those issues may have on exposed environments. Their repeated appearance in this month's vulnerability landscape makes them especially important for defenders to monitor closely, as organizations relying on these technologies may face increased patching demands, greater exposure to exploitation, and a higher need for continuous risk prioritization. By highlighting the most affected vendors, this section helps readers quickly understand where vulnerability activity was most concentrated and which product ecosystems may require more immediate review, remediation, and defensive attention.

Top 10 Vendors by Vulnerability Count Since the Start of 2026

MICROSOFT	539
LINUX	530
APPLE	356
GOOGLE	254
OPENCLAW	189
ADOBE	149
IBM	147
TENDA	142
MOZILLA	123
D-LINK	117

Since the beginning of 2026, the vulnerability landscape has been led by Microsoft and Linux, with 539 and 530 reported vulnerabilities respectively, highlighting sustained exposure across two of the most widely deployed technology ecosystems. Apple and Google also appear prominently with 356 and 254 vulnerabilities, while OpenClaw, Adobe, IBM, Tenda, Mozilla, and D-Link round out the top 10, reflecting notable disclosure activity across software, browsers, enterprise products, and network-connected devices. Taken together, this leaderboard shows that vulnerability pressure in 2026 has remained broad and multi-sector, reinforcing the need for organizations to prioritize patching, review exposure across diverse vendor dependencies, and continuously track high-volume ecosystems throughout the year.

Recent Known Exploited Vulnerabilities

This section highlights recently added entries in CISA's Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) Catalog, focusing on vulnerabilities that have evidence of active exploitation in the wild. Unlike general vulnerability listings, KEV entries carry higher operational urgency because they reflect real attacker activity, making them especially important for patch prioritization, exposure validation, and immediate defensive action.

CVE ID	Vendor / Product	Date Added	Due Date	Ransomware
CVE-2025-53521	F5 - BIG-IP	3/27/2026	3/30/2026	-
CVE-2026-33634	Aquasecurity - Trivy	3/26/2026	4/9/2026	-
CVE-2026-33017	Langflow - Langflow	3/25/2026	4/8/2026	-
CVE-2025-32432	Craft CMS - Craft CMS	3/20/2026	4/3/2026	-
CVE-2025-54068	Laravel - Livewire	3/20/2026	4/3/2026	-
CVE-2025-43510	Apple - Multiple Products	3/20/2026	4/3/2026	-
CVE-2025-43520	Apple - Multiple Products	3/20/2026	4/3/2026	-
CVE-2025-31277	Apple - Multiple Products	3/20/2026	4/3/2026	-
CVE-2026-20131	Cisco - Secure Firewall	3/19/2026	3/22/2026	Yes
CVE-2025-66376	Synacor - Zimbra Collaboration	3/18/2026	4/1/2026	-
CVE-2026-20963	Microsoft - SharePoint	3/18/2026	3/21/2026	-
CVE-2025-47813	Wing FTP Server - Wing FTP Server	3/16/2026	3/30/2026	-
CVE-2026-3910	Google - Chromium V8	3/13/2026	3/27/2026	-
CVE-2026-3909	Google - Skia	3/13/2026	3/27/2026	-
CVE-2025-68613	n8n - n8n	3/11/2026	3/25/2026	-

Conclusion

The findings in this report show that vulnerability risk remains broad, dynamic, and increasingly shaped by real-world exploitation activity, with ransomware continuing to amplify the impact of unpatched and exposed systems. As disclosure volume grows across multiple platforms and products, defenders must look beyond raw counts and prioritize vulnerabilities that present the most immediate operational risk, particularly those likely to support initial access, privilege escalation, or ransomware-enabled compromise. Sustained visibility, rapid validation of affected assets, and disciplined remediation remain critical to maintaining defensive readiness and limiting downstream impact.